

there is a buyer. Those viewing downturns as a buying opportunity can accumulate assets at relatively attractive price levels.

This example is a clear indication that many consumers are taking a long-term approach to investing and resisting doom and gloom prophecies that can lead to emotional decision making.

It's Only a Buck, How Low Can It Go?

Beware of any investments that promise incredible gains. No one can offer such assurance. Although it is tempting to want to believe someone's pledge of huge profits, in reality, if their promise were true, it would be common knowledge. Everyone would want to be getting a piece of the action.

Greed is a strong motivator and one that con artists rely upon. Before you make any decisions which involve spending money, make sure your rational mind, and not your emotional one, is making the decision. Remember that not everyone you come in contact with in business is an honest person. Be wary of any transaction that appears too good to be true. If you remain skeptical and ask lots of questions, you hopefully won't end up like Aaron.

Aaron was a freshman in college and at the age of nineteen was living on his own for the first time. Aaron was reading his mail one night after dinner, throwing away another credit card application from the midst of his junk mail, when the phone rang. He was expecting a friend to call to set up a basketball game on Saturday. The caller turned out not to be his friend, but a wolf in sheep's clothing.

Aaron was caught completely off-guard while the man on the phone excitedly rambled on for almost three minutes about an unbelievable opportunity for certain selected "lucky" individuals to get in on the ground floor of an offshore oil field venture that was about to "take off." Aaron couldn't get a word in edgewise. When Aaron discovered that the man was selling

